

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Security Architecture and Controls | Cloud Security | Identity and Access Management | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM)

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am an experienced Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of progressive experience designing, implementing, and enhancing security architectures and controls across large-scale enterprise environments. I bring a strong technical foundation in cloud security (Microsoft Azure), Identity and Access Management (IAM), network security, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), and endpoint protection, combined with a practical understanding of security governance frameworks including the National Institute of Standards and Technology Cybersecurity Framework (NIST CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, and Cyber Essentials Plus. At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I have led threat modelling exercises, driven security best practices across projects and operations, and served as a senior technical escalation point for complex security incidents affecting over 8,000 users. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and am adept at partnering with senior stakeholders to translate risk assessments into actionable controls. I thrive in collaborative environments and am passionate about contributing to large-scale technology transformation programmes through robust, risk-informed security design.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Architecture and Controls:** Design and implementation of security architectures aligned to NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, and Zero Trust principles
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security design, Azure Policy, Defender for Cloud, secure cloud configuration and governance
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Identity Management
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL); CrowdStrike Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM); detection engineering and use-case development
- **Endpoint Protection:** CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), CrowdStrike Prevent, Insight, Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Network Security:** Firewall policy management (Check Point Harmony), Intrusion Detection and Prevention Systems (IDS/IPS), network segmentation
- **Threat Modelling and Risk Assessment:** MITRE ATT&CK framework, structured threat modelling, security risk assessment and reporting
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Playbook development and automation; PowerShell scripting for security operations
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune (Mobile Device Management / Mobile Application Management), Tanium, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - London, UK

- Design and implement security architectures and controls across an enterprise estate of over 8,000 users, driving security best practices across projects, infrastructure, and cloud platforms.
- Lead threat modelling exercises and security risk assessments for new systems and business initiatives, aligning findings to the NIST CSF and MITRE ATT&CK frameworks and recommending risk-proportionate controls.

- Act as a senior escalation point for complex security incidents, leading triage, investigation, and resolution of high-severity events using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel.
- Drive cloud security initiatives on Microsoft Azure, including Defender for Cloud configuration, Azure Policy enforcement, and secure Identity and Access Management (IAM) design using Entra ID Conditional Access and Privileged Identity Management.
- Develop and continuously improve detection engineering content in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) across the estate.
- Manage endpoint protection across all enterprise devices using CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), tuning prevention policies and response workflows.
- Oversee vulnerability management lifecycle using Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), producing executive-level reporting and driving remediation with cross-functional teams.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM) to enforce least-privilege and device compliance standards.
- Mentor junior security analysts, review their work, and support their professional development in detection, investigation, and response techniques.
- Support ISO 27001 audit readiness and Cyber Essentials Plus recertification, developing policy documentation, evidence packs, and stakeholder briefings.

Cyber Security Analyst - Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - London, UK

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across an 8,000-user estate, integrating all telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for unified SIEM visibility.
- Authored KQL detection rules and analytics queries in Microsoft Sentinel, improving threat detection coverage across identity, endpoint, email, and cloud layers.
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the enterprise estate, configuring prevention policies, detection response workflows, and hunting queries.
- Performed structured security risk assessments for new projects and system changes, providing recommendations aligned to ISO 27001 and NIST CSF controls.
- Designed and implemented Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) Conditional Access policies and Zero Trust architecture controls to reduce identity-based risk.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, managing remediation tracking and producing risk reporting for senior stakeholders.
- Supported cloud security configuration reviews and provided technical guidance on secure design patterns for Azure-hosted services.
- Contributed to the development of security policies, standards, and guidelines aligned to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Managed Check Point Harmony firewall rules, IDS/IPS policies, and perimeter security controls across the network boundary.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech) - London, UK

- Delivered security engineering across a cloud-first SaaS and FinTech environment, implementing and managing infrastructure security controls, identity management, and endpoint protection tooling.
- Managed network perimeter security including firewall configurations, VPN access, and network segmentation to protect internal and cloud-hosted assets.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and collaborated with development teams on secure configuration standards and CIS Controls baselines.
- Administered IAM controls including MFA, SSO, and RBAC across cloud applications, supporting a Zero Trust access model.
- Supported security risk assessments and contributed to DevSecOps practices within the Agile software development lifecycle (SDLC).

- Investigated and responded to security incidents, producing post-incident reports with root cause analysis and remediation recommendations.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and led the deployment of a unified endpoint security and SIEM architecture across an 8,000-user enterprise, integrating CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Microsoft Sentinel, Defender for Endpoint, and Defender for Identity into a single detection and response ecosystem.
- Implemented a structured threat modelling programme and MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection coverage review, identifying and closing significant detection gaps across the estate.
- Reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) to security incidents by building automated SOAR playbooks and KQL-based alert logic, eliminating manual steps for the most frequent alert categories.
- Led Cyber Essentials Plus and ISO 27001 audit preparation, contributing to successful certification outcomes for UAL.
- Deployed Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate security controls against real-world attack scenarios, improving the organisation's security architecture iteratively.
- Established a comprehensive Privileged Access Management (PAM) governance framework via BeyondTrust, reducing privileged account sprawl and strengthening audit trail coverage.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (Leeds / UK)